Session 7 (PROTECT & WRITE: ethics, integrity, Methods and Results): Exercise sheet

Foundations of Clinical Research · Level 1 · Neudata · *#ClearDataClearImpact* · Week 7 · Saturday 12 December 2026 · online, 19:30–22:30

Name: _____ **Department:** _____

Type your answers into this Word file or print the PDF.

Part	Task	When
A	Integrity scenarios: green, amber or red?	End of section 7.2, finish at home
B	Proposal builder 7: write Part 4 of your proposal (ethics, registration, feasibility, publication plan)	In class, before the break. Anything left: at home
C	**Manuscript workshop 1**: write the Results section for your own FLUID-ICU question	After section 7.3 (45 minutes), finish at home

Files you need (sent by email): the results pack for your question (`Results_Pack_QN.pdf`), the manuscript template (`Manuscript_Template_IMRaD.docx`), Paper 1 (Boulet 2024) and Paper 2 (Hyun 2023).

Part A: Integrity scenarios: green, amber or red?

Task. For each scenario, choose a colour and write one sentence explaining why. In class, do scenarios 1, 3, 4a and 4b alone, then vote in the poll and be ready to give your reason when the instructor asks. Do scenarios 2, 5 and 6 at home.

> **Choose from: GREEN** = acceptable as described · **AMBER** = acceptable **only if** something is fixed or disclosed (say what) · **RED** = research misconduct or a serious breach. Do not do it.

#	Scenario	Colour	Why?
1	Three patients' day-3 fluid charts are lost. A resident "remembers roughly" what their balances were and enters values so the dataset is complete.		
2	After seeing the results, the team removes two patients with "strange" fluid values because they weaken the association. The paper does not mention it.		
3	The head of department did not take part in the study but asks to be last author "because it is my department".		
4a	A nurse uses an AI chatbot to improve the English of the Discussion she wrote, checks every sentence, and states this in the Acknowledgements.		
4b	A colleague uploads the study spreadsheet (names and hospital numbers included) to a free public chatbot and asks it to "run the statistics".		
5	A cohort of patients with sepsis like FLUID-ICU is published as three papers (mortality, acute kidney injury and ICU stay) in three journals, none mentioning the others.		
6	Two paragraphs of a published review are copied word for word into your Introduction. The review is cited at the end of the paragraph, but there are no quotation marks.		

Part B: Proposal builder 7: ethics, registration, feasibility and publication plan

Task. Fill in this worksheet for **your own** proposal. In class, the instructor first fills in each block for the running example (a retrospective cohort of fluid balance and 28-day mortality in adults with septic shock in our ICU). After each block, write your own answer alone and be ready to read it out when the instructor asks. If you do not finish in class, complete the rest at home.

Your answers become Part 4 of your written proposal and slides 5 (ethics and feasibility) and 6 (publication plan) of your presentation. Email the written proposal and the 6 slides before 19:30 on Saturday 19 December 2026, Session 8 (`Proposal_Brief.pdf`).

B1. Ethics and consent

Question	Your answer
Which ethics committee will review the study? What type of review do you expect (exempt / expedited / full)? The committee decides.	
Who are the participants, and can they decide for themselves when they become eligible?	
Who gives consent (patient / legal representative / deferred consent / waiver requested)? Use the ICU consent flowchart (Session 7 slides).	
Who takes consent, when and where?	
What are the risks and burdens for participants, and how are they minimised?	
Does the study need registration? Trials: yes, before the first patient, in ClinicalTrials.gov or another WHO registry. Systematic reviews: PROSPERO. Observational studies: recommended.	

B2. Confidentiality

Question	Your answer
Which direct identifiers will you collect (if any), and why?	
How will each patient get a study code?	
Where is the identifying file (study code linked to identity) kept, and who can open it?	
Where will the de-identified data be stored (institution-approved, password-protected)?	

B3. Feasibility check (tick and comment)

✓	Question	Comment
☐	**Time:** realistic timeline (ethics 1–3 months, recruitment, analysis, writing)?	
☐	**Money:** budget headings named (staff time, materials/tests, publication fee)?	
☐	**People:** who collects data (nights, weekends), who analyses, protected time?	
☐	**Patients:** how many eligible patients did your unit see last year? How many can you realistically enrol?	
☐	**Data:** are the key variables recorded routinely? How much is likely missing?	

Biggest feasibility risk: _____ One fix: _____

B4. Publication plan (slide 6 of your presentation)

Item	Your answer
Working title (from your PICO: design, I vs C, P, O, in 10 to 16 words)	
Target journal (and a back-up), checked in the Directory of Open Access Journals (DOAJ) and the National Library of Medicine (NLM) Catalog, with fees and licence known	
Reporting guideline (CONSORT / STROBE / STARD / PRISMA / SPIRIT / CARE)	
Registration needed? Where? (from B1)	
Authors (all four criteria of the International Committee of Medical Journal Editors, ICMJE) and their roles (Contributor Roles Taxonomy, CRediT)	
Conflicts of interest and funding to declare	
Data-sharing statement (what, where, under which conditions)	
Conference where you would present an abstract first	

Structured-abstract skeleton. One line each. Results are the results you *expect to report* (format, not numbers).

Section	One line
Background	
Methods	
Results (expected)	e.g. "28-day mortality: n/N per group, RR (95% CI)"
Conclusion	Write the sentence you would use if the result is positive, and the one you would use if it is not.

Part C: Manuscript workshop 1: the Results section for your question

Task. For the whole workshop (45 minutes), write the **Results section for the question you chose** (Q1 to Q5), using only the results pack for that question. Work through the five blocks below in order. For each block, the table shows where the numbers are in your pack and gives one model sentence from Q1. The Q1 sentences show the style only. Do not copy them, even if you chose Q1. Ask the instructor in the chat when you are stuck. Finish at home and hand in the full Results section (see "Deliverable" below).

Timing, as on the slides: blocks 1 to 4 (STROBE 13 to 16) in part 1 (25 minutes), block 5 (STROBE 17), the list of tables and figures and the number check in part 2 (20 minutes).

Question	Topic	Results pack
Q1	Positive fluid balance by day 3 and 28-day mortality	`Results_Pack_Q1.pdf`
Q2	Cumulative fluid balance and acute kidney injury (AKI)	`Results_Pack_Q2.pdf`
Q3	Cumulative fluid balance and ventilator-free days	`Results_Pack_Q3.pdf`
Q4	Initial lactate and 28-day mortality, complete case vs multiple imputation	`Results_Pack_Q4.pdf`
Q5	Fluid balance and ICU length of stay among survivors	`Results_Pack_Q5.pdf`

Where to find the numbers in your pack

The blocks follow items 13 to 17 of STROBE (Strengthening the Reporting of Observational Studies in Epidemiology).

Block	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5
1. Participants (13)	Section 2	Section 2	Section 2	Section 2	Section 2
2. Baseline and missing data (14)	Table 1	Table 1	Table 1	Tables 1 and 2, Figure 1	Table 1
3. Outcome per group (15)	Table 2, Figure 1	Tables 2 and 3, Figure 1	Table 2, Figures 1 and 2	Table 3, Figure 2	Table 2, Figures 1 and 2
4. Main result, crude and adjusted (16)	Tables 3 and 4, Figures 2 and 3	Table 4 (per 10 ml/kg), Figure 2	Table 3 (per 10 ml/kg)	Table 4 (unadjusted and adjusted), Figure 3	Table 3 (log-linear, crude and adjusted)
5. Other analyses (17)	Tables 5 and 6, Figure 4	Table 4 (positive vs negative, AKI stage 2 to 3)	Table 3 (positive vs negative, Mann-Whitney)	Table 4 (models with SOFA)	Table 3 (Mann-Whitney, per 10 ml/kg)

Write your Results, block by block

Rules for every sentence: numbers exactly as in your pack, percentages with n/N, every estimate with its 95% confidence interval (CI), past tense, "associated with" and no interpretation.

Block	Model sentence (Q1, for style only)	My sentences (my question)
1. Participants: enrolled, analysed, excluded, with reasons	"Of 620 patients enrolled, 618 had a day-3 fluid balance and were analysed. The adjusted model included 527 patients with complete data."	
2. Baseline characteristics and missing data	"Patients with a positive balance had a higher median SOFA score than those with a negative balance (8 [IQR 6 to 10] vs 6 [4 to 8]). Lactate was missing in 91 of 618 patients."	
3. Outcome numbers per group, with denominators	"By day 28, 134 of 373 patients (35.9%) with a positive balance and 45 of 245 (18.4%) with a negative balance had died (Table 2)."	
4. Main result: crude and adjusted, with 95% CI	"The crude odds ratio (OR) for death was 2.49 (95% CI 1.70 to 3.70). After adjustment it was 1.62 (95% CI 1.02 to 2.59, n = 527) (Table 3)."	
5. Other analyses in your pack	"With multiple imputation (n = 620), the adjusted OR was 1.70 (95% CI 1.09 to 2.64) (Table 6)."	

Every table and figure in my pack

List each table and figure in your pack. Tick when it is in your draft, and note where the text cites it. Your submitted Results must include all of them (`Manuscript_Brief.pdf`).

Table or figure in my pack	In my draft?	Cited in the text (block)
	☐	
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Question-specific reminders

- **Q3:** ventilator-free days are skewed and count death as zero.
- **Q4:** report both the complete-case and the multiple-imputation estimates.
- **Q5:** survivors only. Use medians and interquartile ranges (IQR).

Finish at home

- ☐ All five blocks written, with every result in your pack
- ☐ Every table and figure from your pack included, cited in the text and able to stand alone (title, units, n, abbreviations)
- ☐ No interpretation ("because", "suggests") and no causal words
- ☐ A working title and the AI-use statement

Methods (taught in 7.3, optional to submit)

If you also submit the Methods, use STROBE items 4 to 12: design and setting, participants, variables, data sources, bias, study size ("all eligible patients in the cohort were included"), statistical

methods and missing data. The facts are in your results pack, the statistical analysis plan (`SAP_FLUID-ICU.pdf`) and `Data_Dictionary.pdf`.

Deliverable

Your Results section, named `Surname_Firstname_Results_QN.docx`, emailed to your reviewer and to the instructor (myluong1710@gmail.com) **by 23:59 on Sunday 20 December 2026 (Vietnam time)**. It reports all the results in your pack (`Manuscript_Brief.pdf`). Your reviewer is announced at the end of today's session.